



The Importance of Male Friendships

Counseling For Men



Way too many of the men I work with do not have deep friendships. This goes for the married guys, the single guys, the guys who are in a relationship, their closest connection is with their partner/spouse/husband/wife.

But it's just not enough.

No man is an island, said John Donne. I have the idea that I *should* be able to find a number on us. A word I'm us



Get Started with Therapy!

Schedule a Session with Justin

Powered by **vcita**

something to strive for and it's somewhere between 1) I am completely reliant on someone else (this idea brings up terror for most men I know) and 2) I am complete on my own and can figure out any situation.

Again, it's just not enough.

There is incredible value in being vulnerable and being able to express emotions such as sadness, guilt, and fear. Some guys can do this with their partner, but find it very hard to consider showing that to a male friend. I hear lots of reasons why:

- I don't want to bother them
- They're probably very busy
- They'll think less of me (e.g., I'm weak)

What I find fascinating is how when I ask what *they* would think if a friend called them to talk about something vulnerable none of those reasons appear. They want to be there for their friend. But being the one to reach out seems impossibly hard.

How Do I Start?

Social connections positively impact both physical and mental health. Male friendships, in particular, have been associated with lower levels of stress, anxiety, and depression.

I'm going to write that again because for so many people it seems counterintuitive:

Male friendships, in particular, have been associated with lower levels of stress, anxiety, and depression.

Consider what your life would be like if that could be the case. It may just be waiting for you after the start of one text or phone call.

Action step: What friend would you *want* to hear from if they were struggling? *That's* who you should reach out to.

Feel free to blame me: "Hey, friend about vulnerability. Is this a difficult moment I had with r

Tell the person you're not looking for your problem. You just heard



Get Started with Therapy!

Schedule a Session with Justin

Powered by **vcita**

are about well, whatever it is: your mother’s health, your partner’s work stress, your infant who you can’t get to stop crying at 2:30am.

Male Friendships May Save You

Male friendships are too important to be underestimated. Breaking free from societal expectations and stereotypes surrounding masculinity allows men to form deep, meaningful connections that contribute to emotional resilience, stress reduction, and improved mental health. In fact, men who do this don’t just benefit themselves, but they have better relationships with partners, their children, even their parents and siblings.

That first phone call (or if you’re a millennial or younger, text message) is probably the most difficult step.

But by fostering open communication, supporting one another through life’s challenges, and prioritizing the importance of friendship, men can build a foundation of well-being that positively impacts every aspect of their lives.

Contact us to get started today or learn more about how counseling for men can help you.

Search

Blog Categories

Anxiety Therapy

Counseling For Men

Depression Therapy

Online Therapy

Relationship Counseling

Therapy For New Fathers

Uncategorized

What Others Are Saying



Get Started with Therapy!

Schedule a Session with Justin

Powered by **vcita**

"Justin has just the right blend of intellect and sensitivity to lead you to the insights you want, while giving you the safety and reassurance you need to get there."

Bibi Boynton, LCSW, Child Therapist

"I have known Justin Lioi in a professional and personal capacity for the past 7 years. In that time he has only exhibited the utmost compassion not only for his friends and family but also for his patients and colleagues. He is a highly skilled psychotherapist who is warm and engaging."

Kate Casazza, LMSW, Medical Social Worker

"I never hesitate in sending referrals to Justin because he ensures that he is tuned into whoever walks into his office. I've had the opportunity to observe Justin first hand as we worked together with a client in the past. He is impressive, a good listener and flexible in matching his approach with the person." **Eve Rentzer, LCSW-R**

Contact Me

Your Name (required)

Your Email (required)

Subject (required)

Your Message (required)



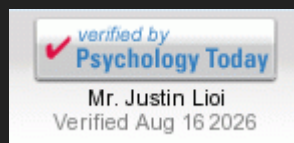
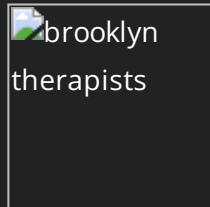
Get Started with
Therapy!

Schedule a Session with Justin

Powered by **vcita**

MKQ 6

Send



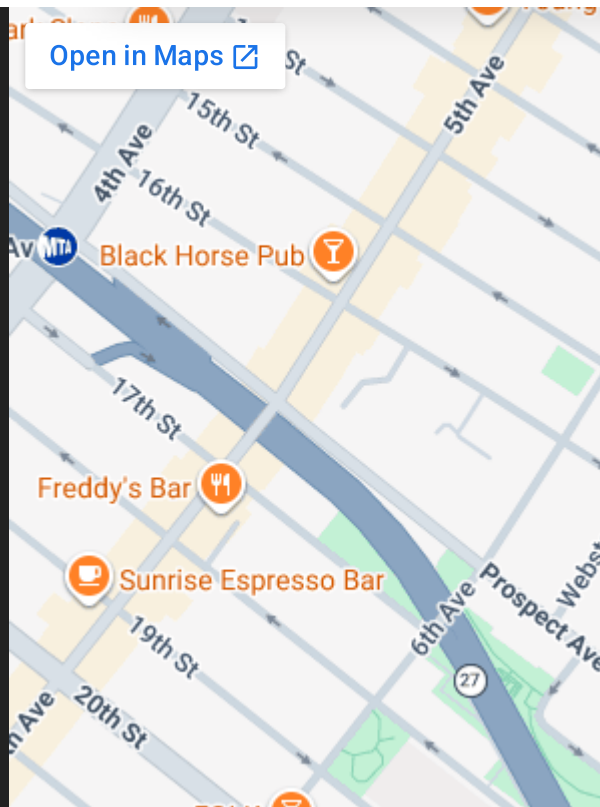
Online Counselling



Get Started with Therapy!

Schedule a Session with Justin

Powered by **vcita**



COUNSELING FOR MEN

JUSTIN LIOI, LCSW

Online Therapy for all of New York

Licensed in NY/VA/NJ

[\(646\) 872-6151](tel:(646)872-6151)

247 Pros



Get Started with
Therapy!

Schedule a Session with Justin

Powered by **vcita**



Get Started with
Therapy!

Schedule a Session with Justin

Powered by **vcita**